

Project Status Report

BookExchange - ENSE 281 Group Project

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Submission	March 18, 2026
Project Type	Working localhost prototype of a student book marketplace
Repository	281-Group-Project (GitHub)

1. Project Overview

BookExchange is a web-based marketplace prototype designed to help university students buy and sell used books directly with each other. The current version demonstrates the main marketplace workflow on a localhost environment: users can browse listings, post books for sale, open item details, contact sellers through email, review their own listings, and delete listings that are no longer needed.

2. Prototype Scope and Delivery Context

The team intentionally focused this deliverable on a functional prototype that could be demonstrated locally without paid hosting or domain costs. For that reason, the application is currently run in a localhost setting and is presented as a work-in-progress software prototype rather than a deployed public product.

3. Implemented Features

Feature	Status	Notes
User login	Partial	Basic login exists in the prototype but is not a complete authentication system.
Browse books	Implemented	Users can browse currently available listings.

View book details	Implemented	Users can open listing details before deciding to contact the seller.
Post books	Implemented	Users can create new book listings.
Contact seller by email	Implemented	The prototype supports contacting sellers through email.
My Listings	Implemented	Users can view the listings they created.
Delete listing	Implemented	Users can remove listings from the system.

4. Explicitly Out of Scope for This Deliverable

To keep the prototype achievable within the available time and resources, the following items were considered out of scope for the current deliverable:

- Full user authentication system
- In-app messaging between buyers and sellers
- Peer rating / reputation system
- Paid hosting, production deployment, and custom domain setup

5. What the Team Has Accomplished

- Completed a working end-to-end marketplace prototype in a localhost environment.
- Implemented the main listing workflow from viewing books to posting and deleting listings.
- Enabled direct seller contact through email instead of building an in-app chat system.
- Delivered a prototype suitable for a live classroom demo.

6. Current Limitations and Known Gaps

- The system is not publicly deployed and must be run locally.
- The login element is not yet a secure, production-ready authentication workflow.
- Communication is handled through email rather than a built-in messaging tool.
- The prototype does not yet include a peer rating or trust mechanism.

7. Technical Approach

The project is organized as a lightweight web application prototype. Based on the repository documentation, the current implementation uses a simple front-end stack and local browser storage / localhost execution to keep the solution feasible for the course deliverable. This approach allowed the team to prioritize usable core features before investing in advanced infrastructure.

8. Demo Plan for the Scrum / Report-out

- Show the landing page and explain the purpose of BookExchange.
- Demonstrate browsing existing book listings.
- Open a listing details page.
- Show how a user can post a new book.
- Open My Listings to show seller-side management.
- Delete a listing to demonstrate state changes in the prototype.
- Show the email-based seller contact workflow.
- Conclude by explaining which features are intentionally out of scope.

9. Next Steps Beyond This Deliverable

- Replace the partial login flow with a secure authentication system.
- Add validation, stronger error handling, and cleaner UI feedback.
- Consider in-app messaging as a future enhancement.
- Consider a peer rating or review system to improve trust and safety.
- Deploy the application when hosting resources become available.

10. Team Reflection Summary

This deliverable helped the team practice translating a simple product idea into a demonstrable software prototype. The team is most proud of producing a working application flow under practical limitations, especially while balancing time, scope, and technical complexity. The activity also reinforced the value of narrowing scope early, documenting trade-offs clearly, and prioritizing a stable demo over unfinished advanced features.

11. Submission Notes

- Convert this document to PDF and upload both the DOCX and PDF versions to GitHub.
- Pair this status report with the scrum/report-out document used for the in-class presentation.
- Include screenshots in the GitHub docs folder if possible to strengthen the submission.